



MICHAEL BRACEWELL

Michael Bracewell is not a youngster; rather, he is a late bloomer, though cricket runs in his blood. Michael, the nephew of Brendon Bracewell and John Bracewell and cousin of Doug Bracewell, comes from a cricketing family.

Making his international debut in 2022 at the age of 31, Michael quickly established himself as a three-format player on the international circuit. Named the 2023 New Zealand Men's ODI Player of the Year, he scored a remarkable 140 off 78 balls against India in the Hyderabad ODI, nearly overshadowing Shubman Gill's double century. The New Zealand spin-bowling all-rounder missed out on the ODI World Cup 2023 in India due to a ruptured right Achilles sustained while playing for Worcestershire in the T20 Blast. In T20Is, Bracewell has taken 24 wickets in 21 matches and scored 167 runs at a strike rate of 125. Recently, he led New Zealand in a five-match T20I series against Pakistan.



MATHEESHA PATHIRANA

Matheesha Pathirana is a true new-age pacer. Part of the new crop of fast bowlers inspired by Sri Lankan legend Lasith Malinga, Pathirana, too, has a slinging action, which makes it awkward for the batters.

Pathirana, who has a knack for picking wickets, has a combined haul of 28 wickets in 12 ODIs and six T20Is.

Having played only six games for the Chennai Super Kings in IPL 2024, Pathirana managed 13 scalps, averaging only 13.00. His overall average in the shortest format is also under 20.

Pathirana's recent form bodes well for Sri Lanka, as he has not gone wicketless in his last 10 T20 matches, totalling 20 scalps.

At just 21, he forms a formidable pace trio with fellow youngsters, Nuwan Thushara and Dilshan Madushanka, for Sri Lanka in the T20 World Cup.